

Elixir: Made for Building Scalable Applications

Each programming language has its own strong points. Choosing the optimal option is the most important factor in building successful software applications. Elixir is a programming language that is well suited for building scalable applications. By using Elixir along with the Erlang VM, you can build applications with very little latency. This article introduces you to the features of the Elixir programming language.

Programming languages play an important role in building successful software applications.

Selecting the optimal programming language suitable for the application that you are building is an important task that needs to be carried out carefully. The availability of many options makes the selection process even more difficult.

This article introduces you to a programming language called Elixir, which has been designed for building scalable applications. With the prolific growth in the number of parallel users and the huge volume of data that is getting generated each second, there is a real need for building scalable applications. Elixir's core philosophy

is to enable building applications that scale, and this has been made possible due to the availability of lightweight threads of execution.

Elixir was created by Jose Valim. A wonderful documentary video released by HoneyPot about Elixir is available at <http://doc.honeyPot.io/elixir-documentary-2018/>.

The first version of Elixir was released in 2011. The latest stable release of Elixir is version 1.9.4, which was released on November 5, 2019. Elixir comes with the Apache License 2.0. The design of Elixir is influenced by Erlang, Ruby, etc, and the fact that it is used by companies such as Pinterest and Divvy testifies to its power.

The important attributes of Elixir are illustrated in Figure 1. Prominent

features such as concurrency, scalability and fault tolerance make Elixir a compelling option as the programming language for your application.

Elixir installation

Elixir can be installed in all major operating systems such as MacOS, UNIX and UNIX-like systems, Windows, etc. For Windows, you can simply download the installer and follow the wizard to get the installation done. In the case of MacOS, follow the instructions given below to install:

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brew update
brew install elixir
```

Elixir can be installed in Ubuntu by executing the following commands. The



Figure 1: Elixir's attributes